

Vocabulary

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2026

Overview

- 1 Loans as a map of the past
- 2 Building words — Derivational Morphology
- 3 Meaning differences between languages
- 4 Some cultural key words

Outline

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Loanwords Are a Map of Contact

- Every borrowed word records a **contact**: trade, religion, conquest, fashion
- Old loans blend in; new ones still look **foreign**
- Peel back the layers to read a language's **history**

This week follows Goddard (2005, Chapter 3).

Four Kinds of Loan

Kind	Example	Why borrowed
indigenized	<i>gift, root</i>	so old nobody notices
prestige	<i>crown, judge</i>	the rulers' language
cultural	<i>coffee, sushi</i>	a new thing arrives
calque	<i>sky-scraper</i>	translate the parts: German <i>Wolken-kratzer</i> French <i>gratte-ciel</i>

English: Layer upon Layer

When	From	Examples
800s–900s	Old Norse	<i>take, get, want, die, low</i>
from 1066	Norman French	<i>crown, judge, court, army</i>
from 1400s	Latin, Greek	<i>scientific, describe, bonus</i>
1500s on	the world	<i>canoe, tomato, coffee, tsunami</i>

- Norse was close to Old English, so its words are now invisible
- Latin was the language of learning; printing spread its words

The Farmer's Animal, the Lord's Dinner

on the farm (English)	on the table (French)
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*cow**beef**sheep**mutton*

After 1066, French was the language of the rulers and English that of the common people, giving a **dual vocabulary** for common and formal use

Borrowed Parts Become Productive

ex- ex-wife
-able readable googleable

Learned words came from Latin and Greek, often by way of French — and brought affixes that now attach to anything

Words Travel by Indirect Routes

Word	From	Via
<i>canoe, potato</i>	Taíno	Spanish
<i>tomato, chocolate</i>	Nahuatl	Spanish
<i>coffee</i>	Arabic	Turkish
<i>sushi, tsunami</i>	Japanese	—

These loans mark new foods, objects and practices

Loans Can Change the Sound System

Old English *leaf* [f] *leaves* [v]
 one phoneme /f/, two sounds

after French *fine* *vine*
 two phonemes: /f/ $\neq$ /v/

French loans such as *veal* and *vine* made /v/ a phoneme

Malay: Religion Brought Words

Sanskrit, Pali	<i>rasa</i>	feel, taste
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2nd c. BC on	<i>nama</i>	name
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	<i>guru</i>	teacher
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Arabic	<i>fikir</i>	think
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with Islam, 1200s on	<i>ilmu</i>	knowledge
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	<i>waktu</i>	time
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	<i>haram</i>	forbidden
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- Malay sits at the **crossroads** of India and China
- Indic loans are fully nativised; Arabic ones keep their fricatives and spellings like *kh*: *khabar* “news”

Malay: Trade and Empire Brought Words

Tamil	<i>kedai</i> “shop”, <i>katil</i> “bed”, <i>mangga</i> “mango”
Chinese	<i>teh</i> “tea”, <i>mi</i> “noodles”
Portuguese	<i>gereja</i> “church”, <i>garpu</i> “fork”, <i>almari</i> “cupboard”
Dutch	<i>senapang</i> “gun”, <i>pelakat</i> “placard”
English	<i>tiket</i> “ticket”, <i>kamera</i> “camera”

Regional trade first; European colonisers after the fall of Malacca in 1511

Different Colonisers, Different Loans

	Malaysia	Indonesia	
office	<i>ofis</i>	<i>kantor</i>	< Dutch <i>kantoor</i>
ticket	<i>tiket</i>	<i>karcis</i>	< Dutch <i>kaartjes</i>

Malay borrows from English (Britain), Indonesian from Dutch (the Netherlands)

Thai: Indic Words Are the Formal Register

	Native Thai	Indic
head	<i>hǔa</i>	<i>sǐisà'</i>
eye	<i>taa</i>	<i>phranêet</i>
dog	<i>mǎa</i>	<i>sunák</i>

- Burmese, Thai, Lao and Khmer took Sanskrit and Pali with Theravada Buddhism — and their scripts
- New words are often **calques** on Indic roots: *thoola².that¹* “television” [far.vision]
- European loans are rarer (though becoming common)

Chinese in Mainland Southeast Asia

Lao, from Chinese

toq2 table

ngen2 money

bòò1 not

- Over 1,000 years of contact: Lao, Thai and Vietnamese
- Numbers and **classifiers** especially
- Strongest in Vietnamese, down to basic nouns — and grammar too

Chinese in Korea and Japan

釈迦	<i>Shaka</i>	Buddha
鉢	<i>hachi</i>	bowl
馬	<i>uma</i>	horse

- Borrowing begins in the first millennium AD, with Buddhism: traditionally 552 (*Nihon shoki*; 538 in other sources), from Paekche
- Script, religion and social norms came too

Japanese: Who Brought Which Words

When	From	Examples
mid-1500s	Portuguese	<i>tempura</i>
Edo	Dutch	<i>kokku</i> “cook”, <i>garasu</i> “glass”
Meiji on	French	<i>atorie</i> “studio”, <i>ankēto</i> “survey”
Meiji on	English	<i>terebi</i> “TV”, <i>sararii</i> “salary”

Japan was closed to all Europeans but the Dutch until 1854, so French loans are Meiji or later

Japanese Loans Today: Borrow, Then Rebuild

loan	<i>yogapantsu</i>	yoga pants
	<i>beddo</i>	Western-style bed
clipped	<i>rimōto</i>	remote working
hybrid	<i>ichigo-ēdo</i>	strawberry + “-ade”
	<i>wan-man-kaa</i>	one-man (driver-only) bus

Technology, fashion and popular culture borrow most

Return Loans: 和製漢語 *wasei-kango*

Meiji Japan built new words from **Chinese** morphemes for Western ideas — and China, Korea and Vietnam borrowed them **back**

		Japanese	Mandarin	Vietnamese
科学/科学	science	<i>kagaku</i>	<i>kēxué</i>	<i>khoa học</i>
經濟/经济	economy	<i>keizai</i>	<i>jīngjì</i>	<i>kinh tế</i>
社会/社会	society	<i>shakai</i>	<i>shèhuì</i>	<i>xã hội</i>

Some are new coinages (哲学 *tetsugaku* “philosophy”, 電話 *denwa* “telephone”); others give old Chinese words a new sense (經濟 < 經世濟民 “govern the world, relieve the people”). So a Sino-Japanese word need not be a loan *from* Chinese.

Pseudo-Loans: Made at Home from Foreign Parts

		from
<i>sararīman</i>	office worker	<i>salary man</i>
<i>konsento</i>	power socket	<i>concentric plug</i>
<i>haendeupon</i>	mobile phone	<i>hand phone</i>
<i>apateu</i>	block of flats	<i>apartment</i>

Japanese *wasei-eigo* “English made in Japan”, and Konglish

The Traffic Runs Both Ways

English	from	
<i>tycoon</i>	Japanese 大君 <i>taikun</i>	great lord
<i>ketchup</i>	Hokkien <i>kê-tsiap</i> (via Malay)	fish brine
<i>emoji</i>	Japanese 絵文字 <i>emoji</i>	picture character
<i>amok</i>	Malay <i>amuk</i>	
<i>orangutan</i>	Malay <i>orang hutan</i>	forest person

emoji has nothing to do with *emotion*

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Three Ways to Build a Word

affixation	<i>un-reli-able, sad-ness, re-written</i>
compounding	<i>book-shop, black-board</i>
reduplication	<i>choo-choo</i>

- **Derivation** makes new words; **inflection** changes a word's form for grammar (tense, number)
- Sinitic and mainland Southeast Asian languages have almost no inflection; Japanese, Korean and Austronesian do
- Derivation is more common than inflection in many Asian languages

Compounding: The Main Way to Make Words

- Sinitic and mainland Southeast Asian languages rely on it
- Usually **two** elements: nouns, adjectives or verbs
- Productive, but the meaning is not always predictable

Mandarin Compounds

		literally	means
parallel	花木 <i>huā-mù</i>	flower-tree	vegetation
metaphor	狗熊 <i>gǒu-xióng</i>	dog-bear	bear
verb/adj.	痛苦 <i>tòng-kǔ</i>	painful-bitter	suffering
N ₁ N ₂	台灯 <i>tái-dēng</i>	table-lamp	desk lamp

Productive N₁ N₂ patterns: N₁ is the place, purpose or material of N₂

Japanese Compounds: Native, Sino-Japanese, Foreign

		literally	means
native	<i>aki-zora</i>	autumn-sky	autumn sky
S-J	<i>to-kei</i>	time-meter	clock
S-J	<i>shakai-gaku</i>	society-study	sociology
hybrid	<i>keshi-gomu</i>	erase-rubber	eraser

Compounding is the most productive way to make words in Japanese;
Sino-Japanese compounds dominate technical vocabulary

Rendaku: The Second Part Voices

aki + *sora* → *aki-zora* autumn sky

hito + *hito* → *hito-bito* people

te + *kami* → *te-gami* letter

Native compounds often voice the first consonant of the second element

Japanese Compound Verbs

	literally	means
<i>naguri-korosu</i>	beat-kill	kill by beating (manner)
<i>kaki-ageru</i>	write-raise	write up (aspect)

Native and Sino-Japanese compounds order their parts differently: native OV *hon-yomi* “book-reading”, Sino-Japanese VO *doku-sho* “read-book”

The Action Can Name the Doer or the Tool

	literally	the action	also
<i>hito-goroshi</i>	person-kill	killing a person	a killer
<i>ha-migaki</i>	tooth-polish	brushing teeth	toothpaste

Compound meanings shift from action to agent, instrument or location

Japanese Loves Abbreviations

paasonaru konpyutaa → *paso-kon*

tōkyō daigaku → *tō-dai*

大阪大学 *ōsaka daigaku* → 阪大 *han-dai* not 大大!

- Long compounds are clipped to a preferred length
- Blends merge parts of different words
- Everywhere in the media and everyday speech

Reduplication: Say It Twice

Vietnamese	<i>đỏ</i> red	→	<i>đỏ đỏ</i> reddish
	<i>trắng</i> white	→	<i>trắng trắng</i> whitish
Indonesian	<i>lalat</i> fly	→	<i>lalat-lalat</i> flies

- Far more common in East and Southeast Asia than in English
- Attenuation, intensity, plurality; often partial, often with a sound change — here the reduplicant loses its tone

Rhyming and Chiming

	Indonesian		English
rhyming	<i>kaya-raya</i>	rich	<i>lovey-dovey</i>
chiming	<i>teka-teki</i>	riddle	<i>zig-zag</i>
	<i>bolak-balik</i>	back and forth	<i>flip-flop</i>

Often idiomatic and expressive; extensive in Thai and Vietnamese too

Few Affixes in Sinitic and Mainland Southeast Asia

Cantonese	<i>góng-faat</i>	speak-way	way of saying
	<i>yihndoih-fa</i>	modern-ize	modernize
Thai	<i>kaan-lên</i>	NMLZ-play	playing
Vietnamese	<i>phản-kháng</i>	counter-resist	protest

- Many Vietnamese affixes are Chinese (*phản-* < 反); productive in journalism and academic writing
- Hakka marks gender with suffixes derived from kin terms

Malay: Rich, Productive Affixation

root		derived	
<i>darat</i>	land	<i>meN-</i> <i>men-darat</i>	go ashore
<i>bersih</i>	clean	<i>meN-</i> <i>-kan</i> <i>mem-bersih-kan</i>	to clean

Prefixes, suffixes and circumfixes: *meN-* makes dynamic verbs, *-kan* makes transitive ones

Korean and Japanese: Causative Suffixes

Korean	<i>bo-</i> see	<i>bo-i-</i>	show
Japanese	<i>mi-</i> see	<i>mi-sase-</i>	make someone look

Korean *-i* has several allomorphs; Japanese *-(s)ase* attaches to almost any verb

Summary: Who Uses Which Tool?

	compound	reduplicate	affix
Mandarin, Cantonese	●	◐	○
Thai, Vietnamese	●	●	◐
Japanese	●	◐	●
Korean	◐	◐	●
Malay, Indonesian	◐	●	●

Isolating languages compound; Austronesian, Japanese and Korean affix

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Some Words Have No Equivalent

お見合い	<i>omiai</i>	formal marriage meeting
酒	<i>sake</i>	any alcoholic drink
日本酒	<i>nihonshu</i>	“Japanese sake” — the rice wine

- English borrowed *sake* for the rice wine, but in Japanese it has broadened to all alcohol
- Words for emotions, values and ideals differ too — and so do basic words

Describing Meaning: Polysemy

- Define with **simpler** words, never circular or obscure ones
- **Polysemy**: one word, several related meanings
- Languages **group** meanings differently — so compare the meanings, not just the words

Languages Carve Up Meanings Differently

English	Czech	Malay	Japanese	Mandarin	
<i>nose</i>	<i>nos</i>	<i>hidung</i>			of a person
<i>trunk</i>	<i>chobot</i>	<i>belalai</i>	<i>hana</i>	<i>bízi</i>	of an elephant
<i>beak</i>	<i>zobák</i>	<i>paruh</i>	<i>kuchibashi</i>	<i>zuǐ</i>	of a bird

English	Malay	
<i>live</i>	<i>hidup</i>	be alive
	<i>tinggal</i>	reside somewhere

Grammar Shows When a Word Has Two Meanings

- Each meaning comes with its own **grammatical frame**
- English *live* “reside” needs a place: *live in Prague*
- Malay *buat*: *buat kuih* “make” vs *buat kerja* “do”

Different arguments $\Rightarrow$ different meanings

“There Is” and “Have”: Often One Word

(1) *Ada dua ekor lembu.*

exist two CLF cow

“There are two cows.” [zsm]

(2) *Orang ini ada dua ekor lembu.*

person this exist two CLF cow

“This person has two cows.” [zsm]

Malay *ada*, Mandarin *yǒu*: one argument means “there is”, two arguments mean “have”

Even Water Differs

English	Japanese	
<i>water</i>	水 <i>mizu</i>	cold or room temperature
	湯 <i>yu</i>	hot

atsui mizu “hot *mizu*” sounds odd: Japanese does not have one word for *all* water

How Do Things Break?

Malay

<i>putus</i>	break in two
<i>patah</i>	break, not sever
<i>pecah</i>	break into pieces

Japanese

<i>oru</i>	break off
<i>kowasu</i>	destroy
<i>kiru</i>	cut off

Cantonese also distinguishes how something breaks: *dá laahn* “smash into pieces”

But is English so different? *destroy*, *cut*, *cut off*, *cut out*, *cut through*, *sever*, ...

Coming and Going

- English *come* moves towards the speaker *or* the addressee
- Japanese *kuru*, Malay *datang* and Korean *oda* cannot shift the viewpoint that way

English *I'm coming!*

Japanese *Ima iki-masu!* “now go”

How Many Words for Rice?

How Many Words for Rice?

	English	Malay	Japanese	Cantonese
growing		<i>padi</i>	稻 <i>ine</i>	禾 <i>wòh</i>
raw	<i>rice</i>	<i>beras</i>	米 <i>kome</i>	米 <i>máih</i>
cooked		<i>nasi</i>	ご飯 <i>gohan</i>	飯 <i>faahn</i>

How Many Words for Rice?

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raw	<i>rice</i>	<i>beras</i>	米 <i>kome</i>	米 <i>máih</i>
cooked		<i>nasi</i>	ご飯 <i>gohan</i>	飯 <i>faahn</i>

Cooked rice often means “a meal”: Japanese *gohan*, Cantonese *sihk faahn* “eat rice” “eat a meal”

Older and Younger Siblings

	English	Thai	Mandarin
older brother	<i>brother</i>	<i>phîi</i>	<i>gēge</i>
older sister	<i>sister</i>		<i>jiějie</i>
younger brother	<i>brother</i>	<i>nóu</i>	<i>dìdi</i>
younger sister	<i>sister</i>		<i>mèimei</i>

Relative age sets lifelong seniority in many Asian families

Birth Order in the Name

- Mandarin: “first brother”, “second brother”, ...
- Malay family nicknames: *long* “oldest”, ..., *teh* “fourth”

Kin terms encode family roles, hierarchy and lineage

Feelings Live in the Body: Psycho-Collocations

	literally	means
Malay <i>panas hati</i>	hot liver	angry, worked up
Thai <i>thùuk-cay</i>	correct heart	please, satisfy
Lai <i>thin haaN</i>	liver become liquid	angry
English <i>hot-headed</i>	hot head	quick to anger

A body-part noun + adjective or verb (Matisoff, 1986); Thai, Malay and Lai have dozens — an **areal** feature of mainland Southeast Asia

Words for Nature and Seasons

- Rich vocabularies for weather, plants, insects and fish reflect traditional ways of life
- Japanese poetry has a whole class of **season words** (季語 *kigo*):

五月雨	<i>samidare</i>	early-summer rain
小春日和	<i>koharubiyori</i>	mild day in late autumn

Summary: Meaning Differs, Even for Basic Words

- Some words have **no equivalent**
- Even basic words **split or merge** meanings differently
- Kinship, rice and emotion words show what a culture **cares about**

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Cultural Key Words

- Words around which a culture **organizes** a whole domain
- Common, and turn up in proverbs and sayings
- Often have **no equivalent** elsewhere

English *love, honesty*

Australian *mate*

Japanese *omiai*

Describing Them Without Bias

- English glosses smuggle in English concepts (**ethnocentrism**)
- Instead, explain with **semantic primes**: simple meanings found in every language (Wierzbicka, 1996)

SOMEONE THINK GOOD WANT BECAUSE

This **Natural Semantic Metalanguage** (NSM) can be checked against native speakers' intuitions

Malay *malu*

“shame”, “shy”, “embarrassed”

Aku malu. “I’m ashamed.”

Eh! Malu pulak dia! “Oh, now they’re shy!”

Fear that others will think or say something bad about you ⇒ wanting to avoid them; it keeps people in line

Explication: *malu*

X feels *malu*

X feels something bad because X thinks like this:

people can know something about me

people can think something bad about me because of this

people can say something bad about me because of this

I don't want this

because X feels like this, X doesn't want to be near other people

it is good if people can feel something like this

Malay *sabar*

“patience” — but broader: staying calm, enduring without losing control

Bersabar...

“Be patient...”

Sabar, jangan menangis.

“Calm down, don’t cry.”

Allah sentiasa bersama dengan orang-orang yang sabar

“Allah is always with those who are patient”

Explication: *sabar*

X is *sabar* [at the time]

at this time, X felt something bad

because of this, X could have thought:

I don't want this

I want to do something now

X did not think like this, because X didn't want to think like this

it is good if a person can be like this

Sabar takes inner discipline and self-control

Chinese 孝 *xiào*

filial piety: duty, respect and care for parents, alive or dead

百善孝为先 *bǎi shàn xiào wéi xiān*

“Of the hundred good deeds, *xiào* comes first”

父母恩比山高，比海深 *fùmǔ ēn bǐ shān gāo, bǐ hǎi shēn*

“What our parents give us is higher than a mountain,
deeper than the ocean”

Explication: 孝 *xiào* (1)

everyone can think about some other people like this:

this person is my father, this person is my mother

I exist because of them

because of this when I think about them I feel something very good

I cannot think about other people like this

it is good if a person thinks about these people at all times

it is good if this person feels something because of this

Explication: 孝 *xiào* (2)

it is good if a person thinks about these people like this:

I want them to feel something very good at all times
because of this I have to do many good things for them

I want to do these things

I don't want these people to feel anything bad at any time
because of this I cannot do some things

I don't want to do these things

it is good if a person thinks like this about some people

it is good if a person does many things because of this

it is bad if a person doesn't think like this about some people

Chinese 忍 *rěn*

perseverance: enduring hardship without complaint, for a greater goal

忍气吞声 *rěn qì tūn shēng*

“endure one’s anger and swallow one’s voice”

Long-term goals over immediate desires; a source of inner strength

Explication: 忍 *rěn* (1)

everyone can think like this about some things:

I want these things to happen

I know they cannot happen if I don't do some things

I want to do these things because of this

if I have to do these things for a long time I don't want not to do them because of this

if I feel something bad when I do these things I don't want not to do them because of this

Explication: 忍 *rěn* (2)

it is good if a person always thinks like this

it is good if a person thinks about this when this person feels something bad

it is good if a person thinks about this when someone else does something bad to this person

it is good if a person does many things because this person thinks like this

it is good if a person can be like this

Japanese 甘え *amae*

dependence: taking someone's love and care for granted

“When I am with Y, nothing bad can happen to me”

Modelled on an infant's dependence on its mother; part of all close relationships in Japan

Explication: 甘え *amae*

X feels *amae* towards Y

X thinks like this about Y:

when Y thinks about me, Y feels something good

Y wants to do good things for me

Y can do good things for me

when I am with Y nothing bad can happen to me

I don't have to do anything because of this

I want to be with Y

X feels something good because of this

Japanese 思い遣り *omoiyari*

empathy: knowing what others need without being told
literally “think-give”

Omoiyari no aru ko ni natte ne.

“Please become a person with *omoiyari*.”

Omoiyari no kokoro o taisetsu ni shimashō.

“Let’s treasure the heart of *omoiyari*.”

Keeps harmony and avoids conflict

Explication: 思い遣り *omoiyari*

X has *omoiyari*

X often thinks like this about other people:

I can know what this person feels

I can know what this person wants

I can do something good for this person because of this

I want to do this

this person doesn't have to say anything

because of this, X does something

people think this is good

Conclusions

- **Loans** map contact history: English, Malay and Japanese are built in layers
- Words are built by **compounding**, **reduplication** and **affixation**, in different mixes
- Languages **carve up meaning** differently, even for water, rice and siblings
- **Cultural key words** can be explained without bias in semantic primes

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